Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the conract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 9 7 6 3 ♥ 10 4 3 ♦ 4 ♣ 9 8 4 3	
♠ A 2 ♥ A 9 7 ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ A K Q 7 6		♠ J 10 ♥ K Q J ♦ A Q J 9 8 7 ♣ J 5
	♠ K 8 5 4 ♥ 8 6 5 2 ♦ K 6 2 ♣ 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
2♣	Pass	3♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♦			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by East
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♦

Lead the ♠4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 4 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A 10 5 3 ♣ A J 6 2	
♠ A 9 3 ♥ Q J 7 4 3 ♦ K ♣ K 8 7 4	N W E S	♠ K J 7 5 ♥ A K 6 5 ♦ 8 7 4 2 ♣ 5
	♠ Q 10 6 2 ♥ 10 ♦ Q J 9 6 ♣ Q 10 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
2♣	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♥9

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when West plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if West guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 10 4
♥ K 9 8
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ A 5

♠ 7 6
♥ Q J 10 7 3
♦ 10 5 3
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ K J
♣ K Q 10 9 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
1♠	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠7

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠7, the suit your partner overcalled.

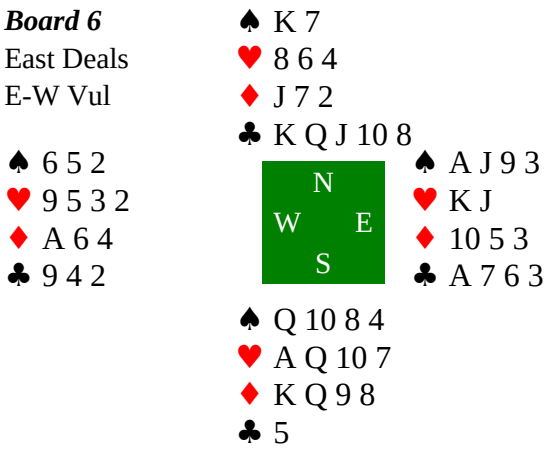
If partner had not overcalled, the ♥Q would be the perfect lead against 3NT. But partner DID overcall, perhaps to give you a hint on what to lead if North became declarer.

As you see, a ♠ lead will defeat the contract this time while the ♥Q would let declarer make 11 tricks.

Consider this: even if partner has a high ♥ to help you establish the suit it is not very likely that you would be able to get the lead with your entryless hand.

There is another, more subtle, reason for leading partner's suit. If the lead turns out wrong, and the ♥Q lead would have beaten the conract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♣	Dbl
All Pass			

1♣X by East
Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 1♣ doubled

Lead the ♣5.

There is only one reason partner would pass your takeout double - he has a great ♣ suit and he expects to inflict a large penalty.

What he wants do do is pull East's trumps so your high card winners don't get ruffed by East. The way you can help him do that is to start with a trump lead.

With the trump lead East might not make more than three tricks.

Board 7
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

Board 9
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 2
♦ A 10 5 3
♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 9 3
♥ Q J 7 4 3
♦ K
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ K J 7 5
♥ A K 6 5
♦ 8 7 4 2
♣ 5

♠ Q 10 6 2
♥ 10
♦ Q J 9 6
♣ Q 10 9 3

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

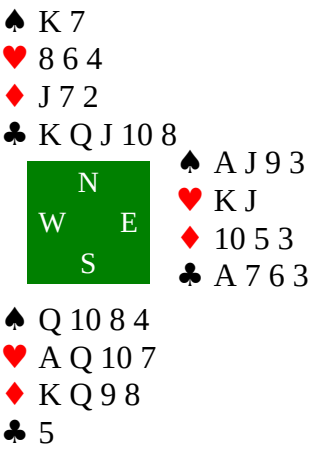
♠ A 10 4
♥ K 9 8
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ A 5

♠ 7 6
♥ Q J 10 7 3
♦ 10 5 3
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ K J
♣ K Q 10 9 4

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul



Board 13
North Deals
Both Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 8 4 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A 10 5 3 ♣ A J 6 2	
♠ A 9 3 ♥ Q J 7 4 3 ♦ K ♣ K 8 7 4	N W E S	♠ K J 7 5 ♥ A K 6 5 ♦ 8 7 4 2 ♣ 5
	♠ Q 10 6 2 ♥ 10 ♦ Q J 9 6 ♣ Q 10 9 3	

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 4
♥ K 9 8
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ A 5

♠ 7 6
♥ Q J 10 7 3
♦ 10 5 3
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ K J
♣ K Q 10 9 4

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 7
♥ 8 6 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ 6 5 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A 6 4
♣ 9 4 2

♠ A J 9 3
♥ K J
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5

Board 19
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

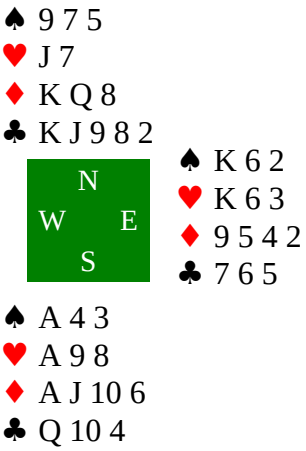
♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

Board 21
North Deals
N-S Vul



Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

Board 23
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 10 4
♥ K 9 8
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ A 5

♠ 7 6
♥ Q J 10 7 3
♦ 10 5 3
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ K J
♣ K Q 10 9 4

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A 6 4
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7
♥ 8 6 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3
♥ K J
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5

Board 25
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

Board 26
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

Board 27
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

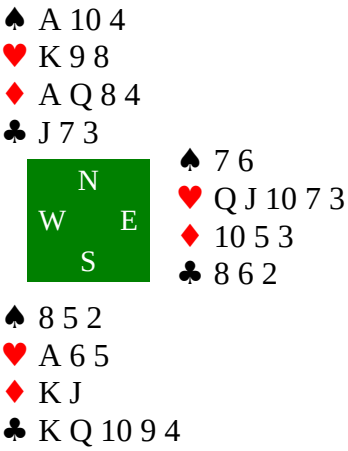
♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

Board 28
West Deals
N-S Vul

Board 29
North Deals
Both Vul



Board 30
East Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A 6 4
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7
♥ 8 6 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3
♥ K J
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5

Board 31
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ A Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 4 2
♦ 9 6 5 4 3
♣ J 9

♠ K J 9 4 3
♥ 6 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2
♥ K 8 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A 8 5 4

Board 32
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

Board 33
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

Board 34
East Deals
N-S Vul

Board 35
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 10 4
♥ K 9 8
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q J 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ A 5

♠ 7 6
♥ Q J 10 7 3
♦ 10 5 3
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ K J
♣ K Q 10 9 4

Board 36
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A 6 4
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7
♥ 8 6 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3
♥ K J
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5